

Principles of Compiler Construction

Prof. Wen-jun LI

School of Computer Science and Engineering

lnslwj@mail.sysu.edu.cn

© Copyright 2008-2022, Sun Yat-sen University

Lecture 11. Code Generation

1. Introduction
2. Abstraction of Target Machines
3. Implementation of Procedures
4. Optimization of Basic Blocks
5. A Simple Code Generator
6. Peephole Optimization

1. Introduction

- Code generators focus on
  1. Instruction selection
     - Choose appropriate target-machine instructions to implement IR statements.
  2. Register allocation and assignment
     - Make full use of registers, the fastest computational unit.
  3. Instruction ordering
     - Decide the order in which the execution of instructions is scheduled.
     - Also called **instruction scheduling**.

Instruction Selection

- Both the speed and the size cost of the generated code should be considered.
  - Trade-off and consequence.
- Example 1: **a = a + 1**
  - ```
    LD   R0, a
    ADD  R0, R0, #1
    ST   a,  R0
    ```
  - ```
    INC  a
    ```
- Example 2: set register R0 to 0
  - ```
    LD   R0, #0
    ```
  - ```
    XOR  R0, R0
    ```

Register Allocation and Assignment

- Include two subproblems
  - Register allocation
    - Select the set of variables that will reside in registers at each point in the program.
  - Register assignment
    - Pick the specific register that a variable will reside in.
- A difficult problem in code generation.

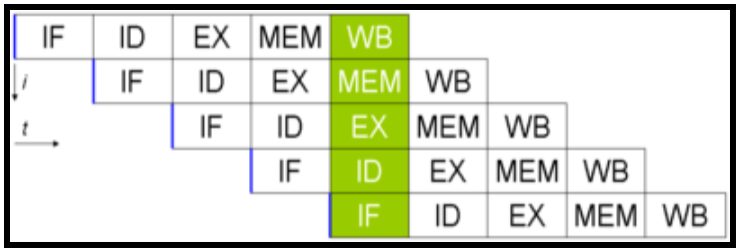
Instruction Scheduling

- Important for modern pipelined processors
  - RISC: Reduced Instruction Set Computer
    - RISC vs. CISC
  - Data Hazards (**stalls** in a pipeline): attempt to use a datum before it becomes available in register.
    - A value written to a register will not be available in its following cycles.
    - The following cycles should be utilized by instructions that does not depend on the value
      - Or they will be wasted.
    - Optimization: clustering instructions with no dependencies together, while preserving original semantics.

Instruction Scheduling (cont')

- An example: **(a + b) + c** on SGI's MIPS 2000

```
LD    R1,  a
LD    R2,  b
NOP
ADDi  R1,  R1,  R2
LD    R2,  c
NOP
ADDi  R1,  R1,  R2
```



- Optimal generated code

```
LD    R1,  a
LD    R2,  b
LD    R3,  c
ADDi  R1,  R1,  R2
NOP
ADDi  R1,  R1,  R3
```

2. Abstraction of Target Machines

- Instruction set
- Addressing modes
- Program and instruction costs

Instruction Set

- Supports the following instructions
  - LD dst, addr // load
  - ST x, Ri // store
  - OP dst, src1, src2 // ADD, SUB, ...
    OP dst, src1 // unary operation
  - BR L // branch
  - Bcond r, L // conditional branch

Addressing Modes

- Addressing in instructions
  - #C // immediate constant, cost = 1
  - x // absolute, cost = 1
  - *x // indirect memory, cost = 1
  - R // direct register, cost = 0
  - *R // indirect register, cost = 0
  - a(Ri) // direct indexed, cost = 1
    - **a** is a variable or a constant
    - LD R1, a(R2)
      - R1 = contents(a + contents(R2))
    - LD R1, 100(R2)
      - R1 = contents(100 + contents(R2))
  - *a(Ri) // indirect indexed, cost = 1
    - LD R1, *100(R2)
      - R1 = contents(contents(100 + contents(R2)))

Program and Instruction Costs

- Cost of an instruction
  - = 1 + operand_addr_cost
- Cost of a program
  - = total of instruction costs
- Examples
  - `LD  R0,  R1` // cost = 1
  - `LD  R0,  x` // cost = 2
  - `LD  R1,  *100(R2)` // cost = 2

3. Implementation of Procedures

- Static Allocation
- Stack Allocation

Static Allocation

- Implementation of **call** *callee*
  - ...
    ST *callee.staticArea*, #*here* + 20 // return address
    BR *callee.codeArea* // jump to Callee
    ...
- Implementation of **return**
  - ...
    BR **callee.staticArea* // return to Caller

Assume that the return address is saved at the **beginning** of the activation record. And **20 = 5 words * 4 bytes/word**

An Example: Three-Address Code

```
// code for c
action1
call p
action2
halt

// code for p
action3
return
```

An Example: Implementation

```
// code for c
100     action1
120     ST   364,   #140      // return address
132     BR   200              // call p
140     action2
160     HALT                  // return to operating system
        ...
// code for p
200     action3
220     BR   *364             // return to its caller
        ....
// activation record for c
300                           // return address to Caller
304                           // local data for c
        ....
// activation record for p
364     140                   // return address to Caller
368                           // local data for p
```

Stack Allocation

- Implementation of initialization
  - LD SP, *#stackStart* // initialize the stack
    ...
    HALT // terminate
- Implementation of **call** ***callee***
  - ...
    ADD SP, SP, *#caller.recordSize* // push an AR
    ST *SP, *#here* + 16 // return address
    BR *callee.codeArea* // jump to Callee
    SUB SP, SP, *#caller.recordSize* // pop the AR
    ...

DBv2 must assume that addressing **0(SP)** has no additional cost

- Implementation of **return**
  - ...
    BR *0(SP) // return to Caller

An Example: Three-Address Code

```
// code for m
action1
call q
action2
halt

// code for p
action3
return
```

```
// code for q
action4
call p
action5
call q
action6
call q
return
```

An Example: Implementation

```
100 LD   SP,  #600
108 action1
128 ADD  SP,  SP,  #msize
136 ST   *SP,      #152
144 BR   300
152 SUB  SP,  SP,  #msize
160 action2
180 HALT
    ...
200 action3
220 BR   *0(SP)
    ....
300 action4
320 ADD  SP,  SP,  #qsize
328 ST   *SP,      #344
```

code for **p**

code for **q**

```
336 BR   200
344 SUB  SP,  SP,  #qsize
352 action5
372 ADD  SP,  SP,  #qsize
380 ST   *SP,      #396
388 BR   300
396 SUB  SP,  SP,  #qsize
404 action6
424 ADD  SP,  SP,  #qsize
432 ST   *SP,      #448
440 BR   300
448 SUB  SP,  SP,  #qsize
456 BR   *0(SP)
    ...
600
```

blue for call sequence

stack

4. Optimization of Basic Blocks

- Approach



Petri Nets in
Super Compiler

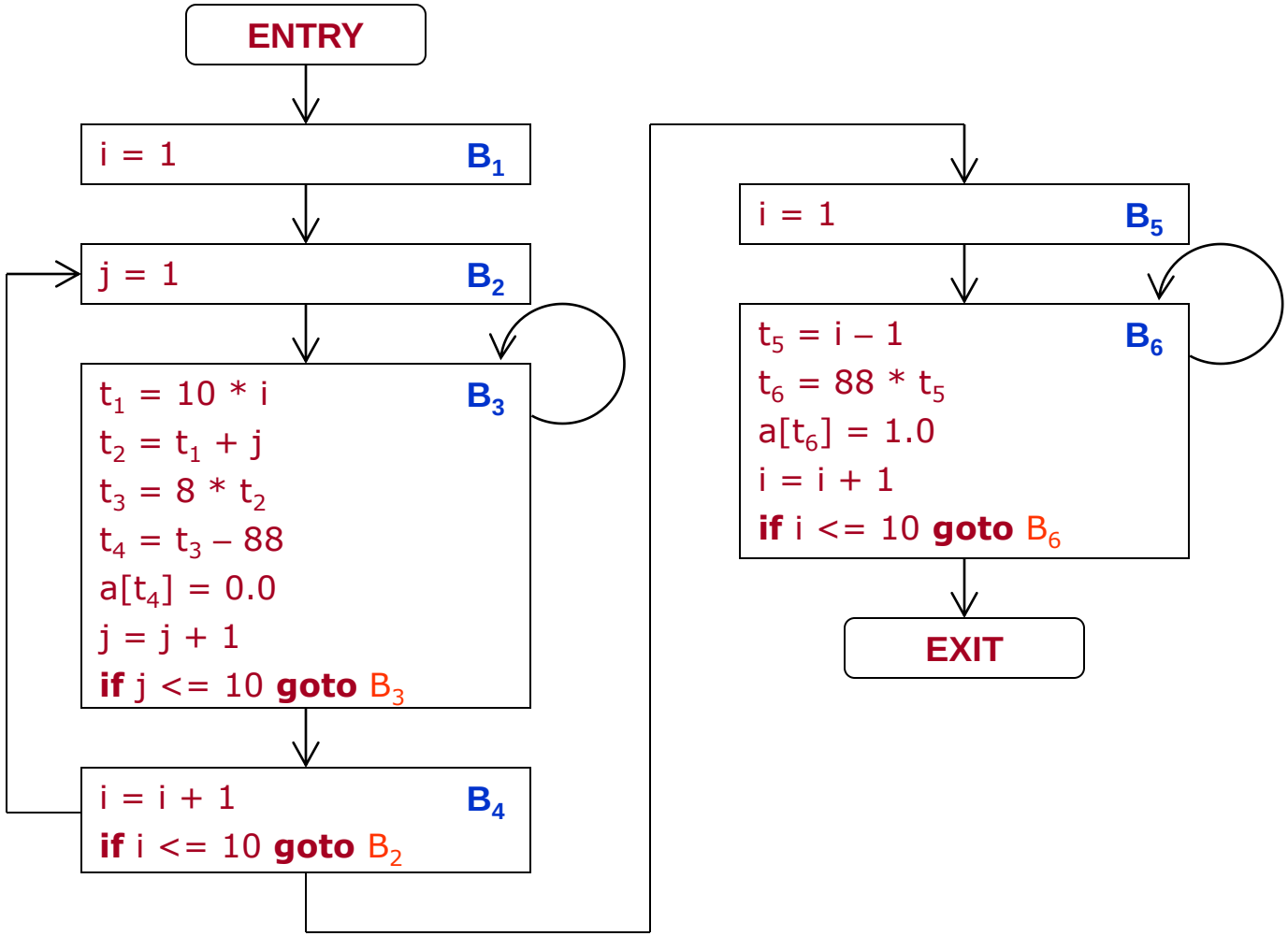
Basic Blocks

- Single entry and single exit
- Example

(1) i = 1
(2) j = 1
(3) t_1 = 10 * i
(4) t_2 = t_1 + j
(5) t_3 = 8 * t_2
(6) t_4 = t_3 – 88
(7) a[t_4] = 0.0
(8) j = j + 1
(9) **if** j <= 10 **goto** 3

(10) i = i + 1
(11) **if** i <= 10 **goto** 2
(12) i = 1
(13) t_5 = i – 1
(14) t_6 = 88 * t_5
(15) a[t_6] = 1.0
(16) i = i + 1
(17) **if** i <= 10 **goto** 13

Flow Graphs


ENTRY
i = 1
B1
j = 1
B2
t1 = 10 * i
t2 = t1 + j
t3 = 8 * t2
t4 = t3 – 88
a[t4] = 0.0
j = j + 1
if j <= 10 goto B3
B3
i = i + 1
if i <= 10 goto B2
B4
i = 1
B5
t5 = i – 1
t6 = 88 * t5
a[t6] = 1.0
i = i + 1
if i <= 10 goto B6
B6
EXIT

Construction of Flow Graphs

- Partition three-address instructions into basic blocks
  - **Leader**: the 1st instruction in a basic block.
  - Algorithm to find all leaders
    1. The 1st three-address instruction
    2. Target of a conditional or unconditional jump
    3. Instruction immediately follows a conditional or unconditional jump

Liveness and Next-Use Information

- Calculate liveness and next-use info in a basic block: backward scanning
  - Initialize: for each variable v,
    - v.nextUse = **none**;
      v.liveness = v is temporary ? **false** : **true**;
  - For each i: x = y + z
    - Attach information of x, y and z to instruction i;
    - x.liveness = **false**;
      x.nextUse = **none**;
    - y.liveness = z.liveness = **true**;
      y.nextUse = z.nextUse = i;

Conservative. Global data-flow analysis in practice

An Example

- Information are stored at the entry of each variables in the symbol table

```
(1) t =  a - b
(2) u =  a - c
(3) v =  t + u
(4) d =  v + u
```



```
(1) t(3),T  = a(2),T - b-,T
(2) u(3),T  = a-,T - c-,T
(3) v(4),T  = t-,F + u(4),T
(4) d-,T    = v-,F + u-,F
```

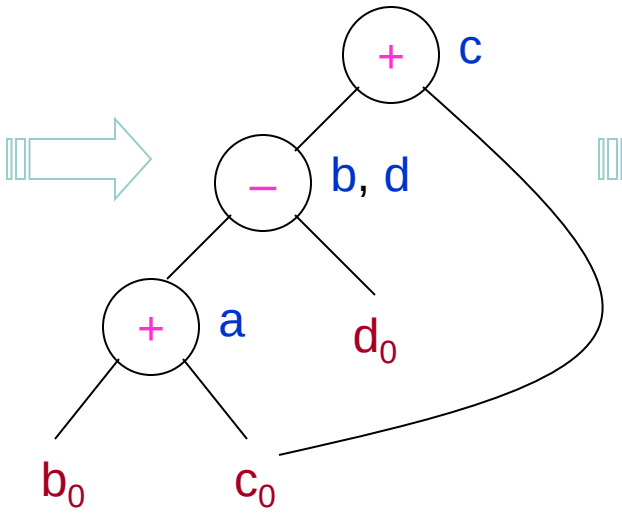
Var.	Next-Use					Liveness				
	Init	(4)	(3)	(2)	(1)	Init	(4)	(3)	(2)	(1)
a	–			(2)	(1)	T			T	T
b	–				(1)	T				T
c	–			(2)		T			T	
d	–	–				T	F			
t	–		(3)		–	F		T		F
u	–	(4)	(3)	–		F	T	T	F	
v	–	(4)	–			F	T	F		

Optimization Based on DAGs

- Perform several code-improving transformations
  - Elimination of local common subexpressions
  - Elimination of dead code
  - Reordering of independent statements
  - Application of algebraic laws

Local Common Subexpressions

```
a = b + c
b = a - d
c = b + c
d = a - d
```

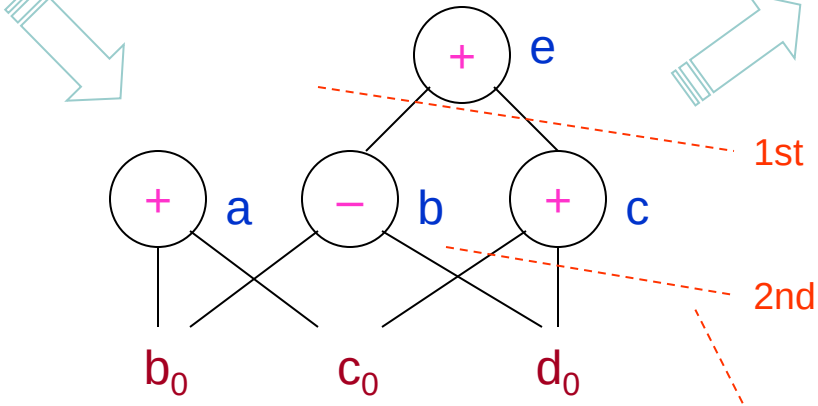



```
a = b + c
d = a - d
c = d + c
b = d
```

Only if b is live on exit

Dead Code

```
a = b + c
b = b - d
c = c + d
e = b + c
```




```
a = b + c
b = b - d
```

Suppose only **a** and **b** are live on exit

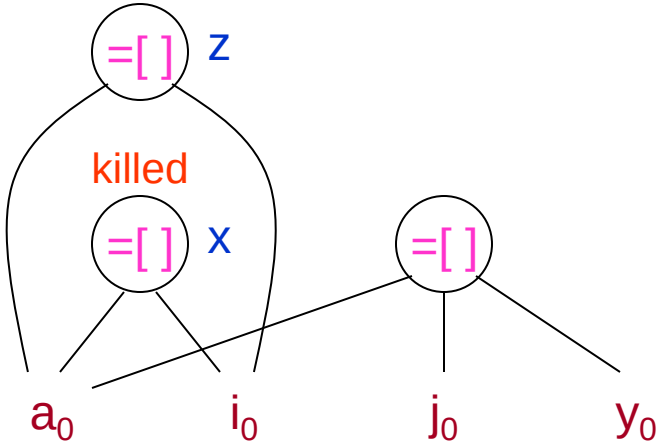
Algebraic Identities

- Arithmetic identities
  - x + 0 = 0 + x = x
  - x * 1 = 1 * x = x
  - x – 0 = x
  - x / 1 = x
  - ...
- Local reduction in strength
  - 2 * x ⇒ x + x
  - x / 2 ⇒ x * 0.5
  - ...
- Constant folding
  - 2 * 3.14 ⇒ 6.28
  - ...

Array References

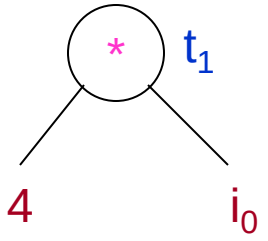
```
x = a[i]
a[j] = y
z = a[i]
```





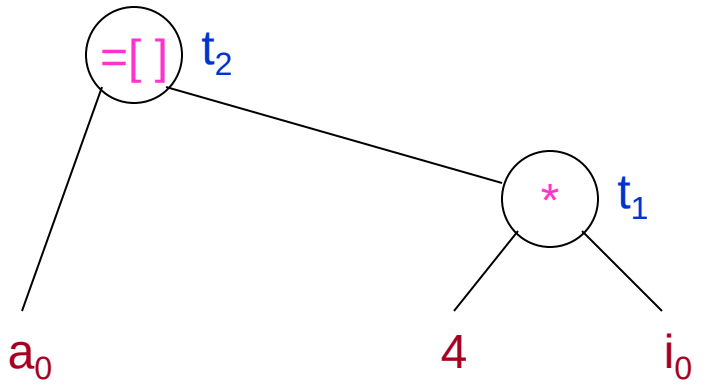
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (1)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



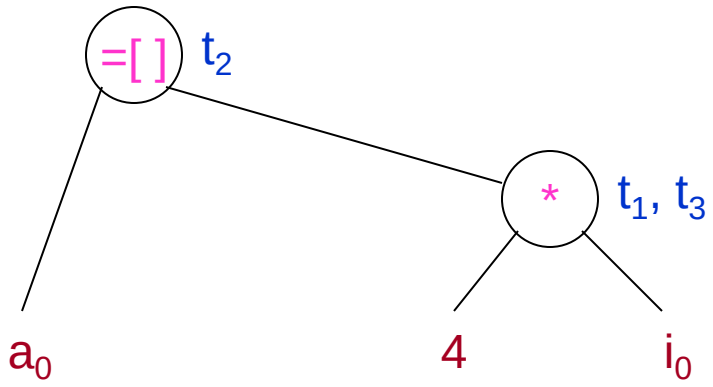
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (2)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



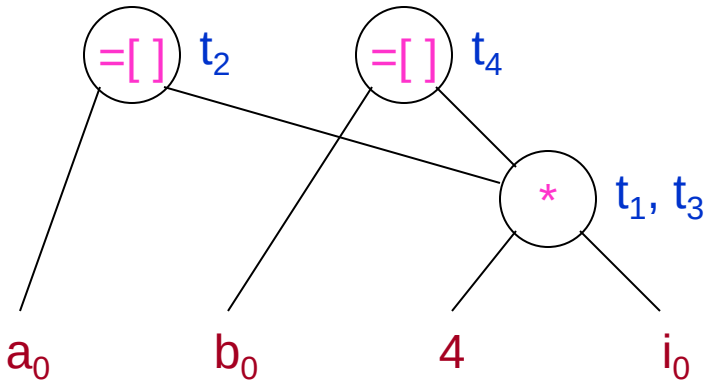
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (3)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



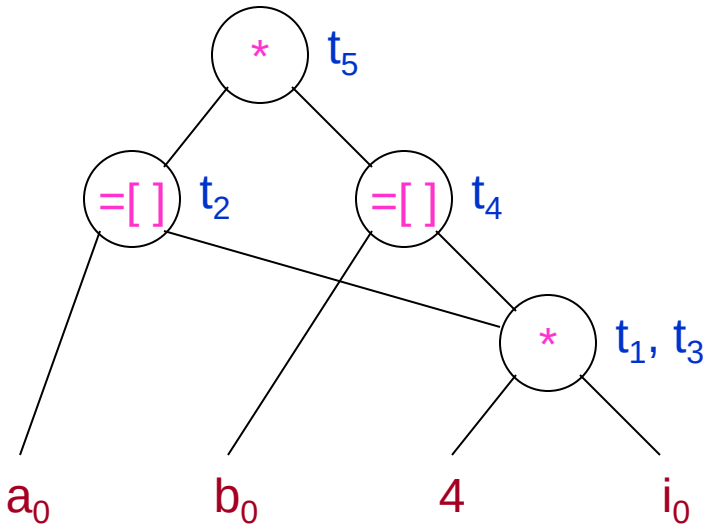
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (4)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



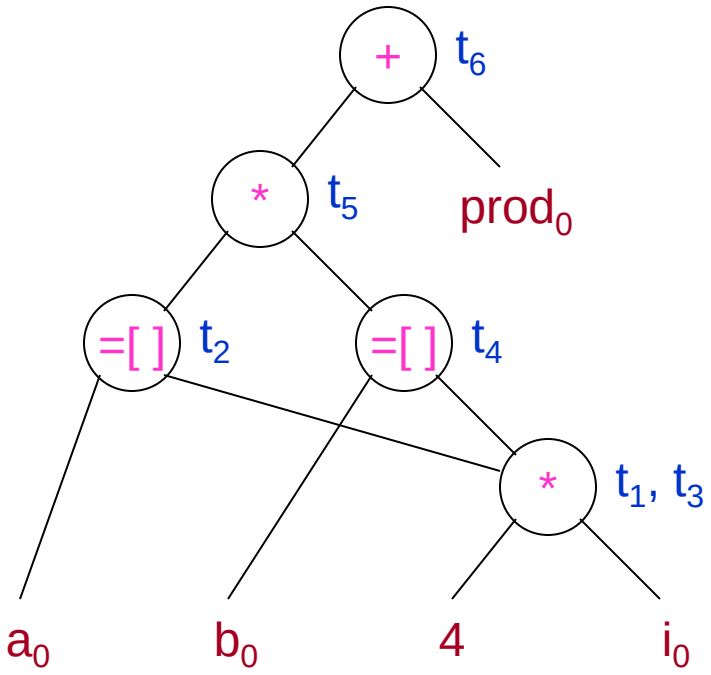
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (5)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



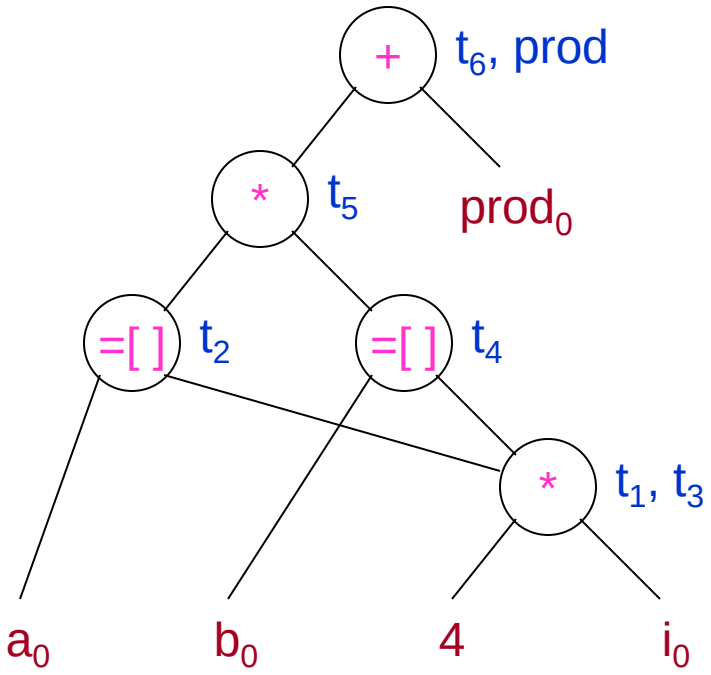
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (6)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



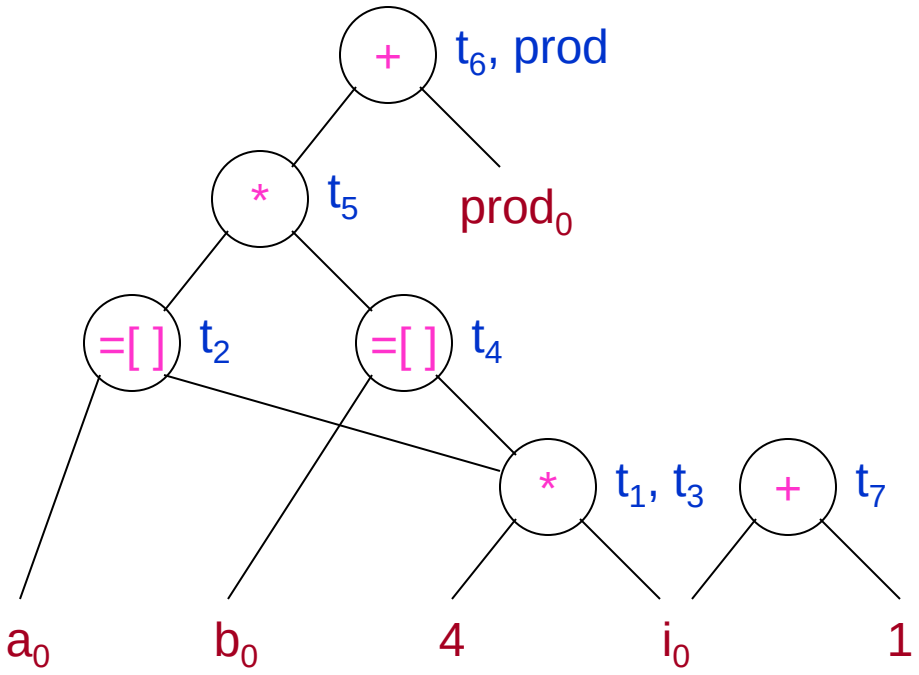
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (7)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



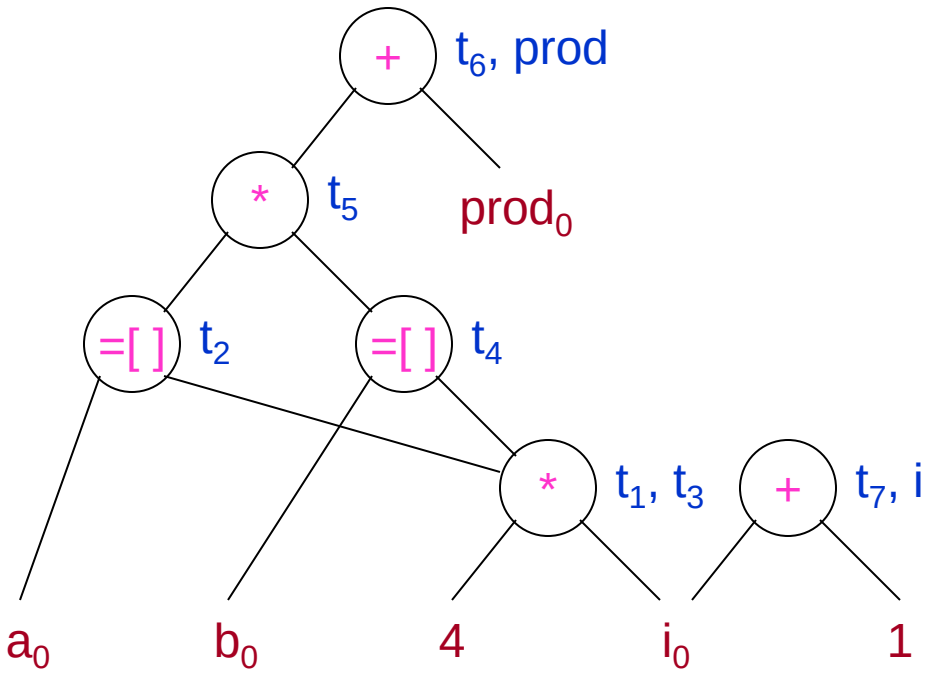
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (8)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



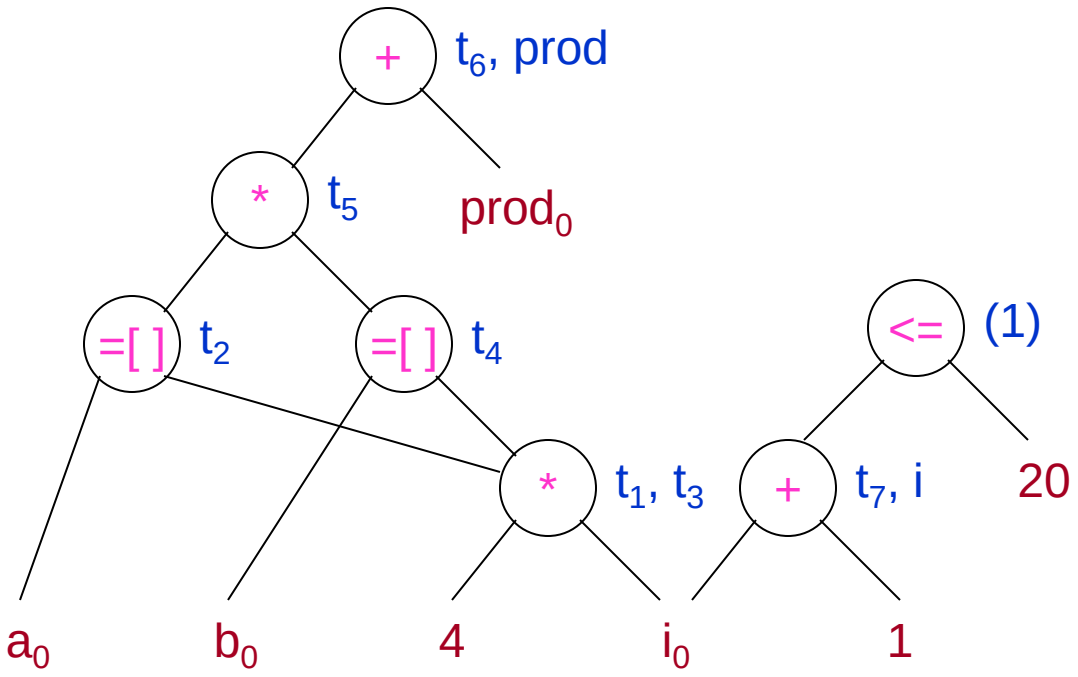
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (9)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



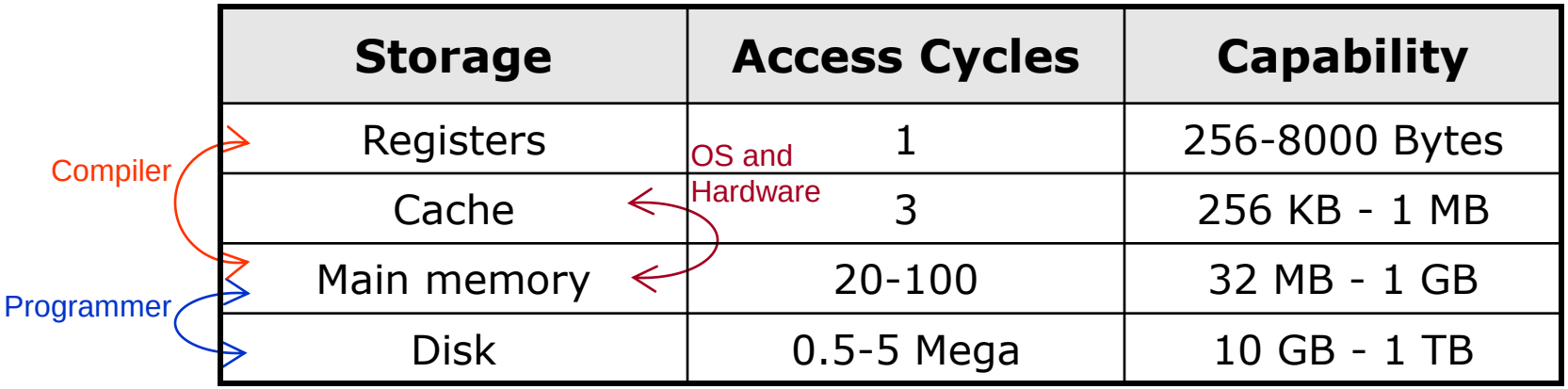
An Example: Construction a DAG from a BB (10)

```
t1 = 4 * i
t2 = a[t1]
t3 = 4 * i
t4 = b[t3]
t5 = t2 * t4
t6 = t5 + prod
prod = t6
t7 = i + 1
i = t7
if i <= 20 goto (1)
```



5. A Simple Code Generator

- What does "simple" mean?
  - Generate code for a single basic block.
- Motivation
  - Make full use of registers to the best advantage.



Storage	Access Cycles	Capability
Registers	1	256-8000 Bytes
Cache	3	256 KB - 1 MB
Main memory	20-100	32 MB - 1 GB
Disk	0.5-5 Mega	10 GB - 1 TB

Register and Address Descriptors

- Register descriptor
  - **RegDesc: Register** $\rightarrow 2^{\textbf{Variable}}$
- Address descriptor
  - **AddrDesc: Variable** $\rightarrow 2^{\textbf{Location}}$
  - **Location = Register** $\cup$ **Memory**

Code-Generation Algorithm

- Based on function getReg(x = y op z)
  - Select registers for variables in three-address instruction x = y op z.
    - That is R_x, R_y and R_z for x, y and z respectively.
  - Make decisions based on the register descriptor and the address descriptor.

Code-Generation Algorithm (cont')

- Machine instructions for $x = y + z$
  - Call getReg($x = y + z$) to select registers R_x, R_y and R_z for x, y and z.
  - **If** $y \notin regDesc(R_y)$, get some $y' \in addrDesc(y)$ and issue an instruction: LD R_y, y'.
  - **If** $z \notin regDesc(R_z)$, get some $z' \in addrDesc(z)$ and issue an instruction: LD R_z, z'.
  - Issue an instruction: ADD R_x, R_y, R_z.
  - Adjust register and address descriptors.

Code-Generation Algorithm (cont')

- Machine instructions for x = y
  - Call getReg(x = y) to select registers R_x and R_y.
    - getReg() will always choose the same register for both x and y.
  - **If** $y \notin regDesc(R_y)$, get some $y' \in addrDesc(y)$ and issue an instruction: LD R_y, y'.
  - Adjust register descriptor: $regDesc(R_y) \cup= \{x\}$

Design of **getReg(...)**

- Input: x = y + z
- Output: R_x, R_y and R_z
- Algorithm (use R_y as an example)
  - **if** y in some registers, pick R_y in them.
  - **elsif** there is empty registers, pick one as R_y.
  - **elsif** { let R be a candidate and R holds v, **foreach** v check:
    - **if** addrDesc(v) has other location, R is OK.
    - **elsif** v == x **and** x != z, R is OK.
    - **elsif** v is not used later, R is OK.
    - **else** spill, i.e. issue ST v, R.
  - choose the R with minimal spills }.

6. Peephole Optimization

- A simple but effective technique for locally code improvement
  - Examine a sliding window (peephole) of target instructions.
  - Replace instruction sequence within the peephole by a shorter or faster sequence.

Eliminating Redundant Loads and Stores

- Examples
  - LD R0, a
    ST a, R0
    // eliminated

Eliminating Unreachable Code

- Examples
  - ```
        if debug == 1 goto L1
        goto L2
    L1: print debugging information
    L2:
    ```
  - ```
        if debug != 1 goto L2
        print debugging information
    L2:
    ```

Flow-of-Control Optimizations

- Examples
  -
```
        goto L1
        ...
L1:     goto L2
```
```
        goto L2
        ...
L1:     goto L2
```
  -
```
        if a < b goto L1
        ...
L1:     goto L2
```
```
        if a < b goto L2
        ...
L1:     goto L2
```

Recall the translation scheme of flow-of-control statements!

Algebraic Simplification and Reduction in Strength

- Examples
  - x = x + 0
    // eliminated
  - x = x * 1
    // eliminated
  - y = x * 2
    y = x << 1
  - y = x * 4
    y = x << 2

Further Reading

- Dragon Book, 2nd Edition (DBv2)
  - Comprehensive Reading:
    - Section 8.1-8.2 on introduction to code generation and abstraction of target machines.
    - Section 8.3 on implementation of procedures.
    - Section 8.4-8.5 on DAG-based block optimization.
    - Section 8.6 on a simple code generator.
  - Skip Reading:
    - Section 8.7 on peephole optimization.
    - Section 8.8-8.11 on more advanced topics.

Enjoy the Course!

